



Eudora 7.1

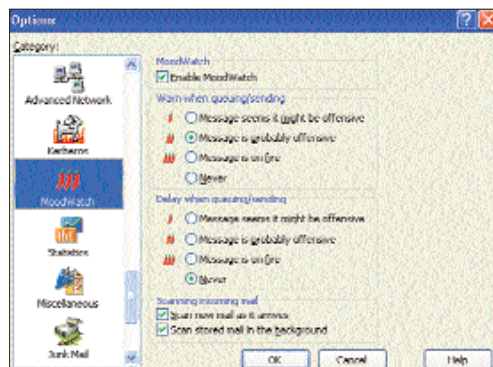
Along with support for POP3 and IMAP, Eudora has a special feature called ESP (Eudora Sharing Protocol) that allows you to create a group of users who can synchronise and share a set of files via e-mail.

The e-mail composer supports plain-text as well as richly-formatted text, and you can even send emoticons if you use the paid version. Then there is MoodWatch—an offensive-vocabulary alert that warns you about profanity if you accidentally type in some. Eudora has extensive search options, and it also supports indexed search for faster performance.

It's SpamWatch Bayesian spam filter is quite effective. Also featured is ScamWatch, which warns you about deceptive URLs in phishing e-mails, but you need to be a paid user to use these.

Eudora's PureVoice plug-in lets you send a voice message as an attachment, and this can be opened by the receiver using the PureVoice plug-in. It also gives you the option to redirect your e-mail to a different address.

This program is available in three versions: Paid, Sponsored, and Lite. The paid and the sponsored versions have the same features, except that the sponsored version is adware. The Lite version has fewer features. At the end of the day, Eudora is a good e-mail client, but will be somewhat tough to get used to. Eudora is set to go open source in the first half of 2007.



MoodWatch guards against profanity



IncrediMail X

This is one of the best looking e-mail clients we have seen, and it seems to be aimed at the young. The download is just 450 KB, but this is a deceiver—it is a Web installer, and over 10 MB is downloaded.

IncrediMail has support for POP3 as well as IMAP, but support for news feeds has been left out.

The interface is similar to that of Outlook Express (OE), only more colourful thanks to Flash, which is what most likely contributes to its slow load times.

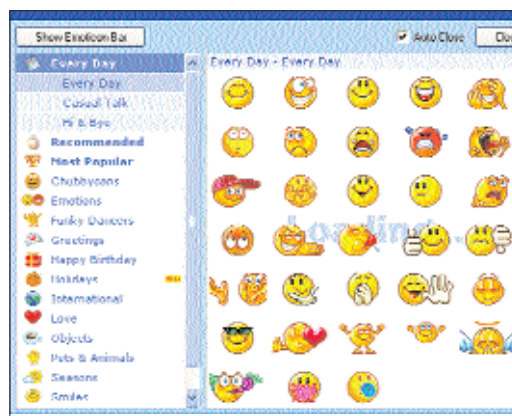
When you open the e-mail composer, along with it opens a Style Box that lets you choose from loads of colourful backgrounds—including some animated ones. You can even choose to add 3D effects and also emoticons. You can send audio mail, where you record a message and mail it with the text.

IncrediMail sits quietly in the System Tray, and when new mail arrives, the Notifiers let you

know. These Notifiers are animated characters—something similar to the search assistants in XP.

IncrediMail's spam blocker automatically determines ad-based messages. The safety concerns are the same as those in OE—maybe even more, considering the presence of Flash content. IncrediMail, too, has the ability to read POP mail without downloading it. This way, you can delete unwanted mail directly from the POP3 server.

With so much colour and animations, we revise our earlier view: this isn't really for teens, but rather for kids being introduced to the world of e-mail!



Convey your emotions using the Emoticons

Windows Mail

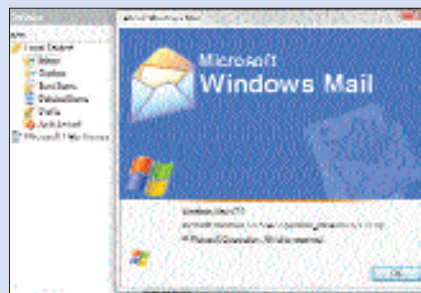
“Finally, Microsoft is taking steps to do away with the buggy-yet-popular version of their e-mail client—Outlook Express. Windows Vista will feature a new e-mail client—Windows Mail.” This rumour has been around on the Internet for the past few months. But the excitement is not warranted: Microsoft has not built this e-mail client from scratch—rather, this is Outlook Express's new avatar.

Let us first look at what new features are offered in Windows Mail. An integrated spell-checker is provided, so you don't need to install MS Office for this feature. It also includes a new storage engine that is more reliable and performs better than OE.

Windows Mail makes use of Internet Explorer 7's Phishing Filter, and also has a Junk Mail filter—similar to Outlook. Other than this, Windows Mail offers only a few cosmetic enhancements over OE.

While it gains some features, it loses quite a few. You can no longer access Web mail accounts like Hotmail (and the soon-to-be Windows Live Mail)—only POP3 and IMAP mail accounts are supported. It also does away with the Identities feature of OE, but this is a feature that was often left unused and hence won't be missed much.

Vista comes with Windows Calendar and Windows Contacts, and integrating Windows Mail with these two would have



Old wine, new bottle

given its good PIM functionality, but it is speculated that Microsoft didn't do so to protect Outlook from being threatened.